

Effective Superintendent Evaluation: A Key to Your Accountability Plan

There are two major components to the evaluation process for Superintendents which seem critical—i.e. the first component deals with the general management/administrative responsibilities of the Superintendent. That would include the standard categories which appear in most Superintendent job descriptions and evaluation procedures.

These are on-going areas of responsibility for a Superintendent. They should be evaluated each year since weakness in any one of the functions would require attention.

There are a myriad of approaches to this general evaluation task.

- It seems important that whatever approach is adopted, it should be complete enough to cover major areas of concern for a Board.
- Another important consideration is ease of use—if a form takes an inordinate amount of time to complete, then for some Board members it will not be practical.
- The tool should permit some degree of evaluation—i.e. strong, weak, high, low, acceptable, unacceptable, etc.
- There should be space for comments—most forms if used on a computer will permit automatic expansion of the comment box for longer responses.
- There should be an easy way to compile the ratings from Board members to help both the Board and Superintendent to notice any areas of particular concern or particular commendation.

If a school district is looking for a sample form, there are numerous places to find examples. There is a notebook from WSSDA which has examples, the WASA staff has examples and there are many districts willing to share the tool that they use. There is also a generic form provided by the Interstate School Leaders Licensure Consortium (ISLLC) that is supported by the State Superintendent's Office as a guide for administrative training programs.

This document provides a general template that a Board could consider for evaluating the Superintendent. It is not perfect, but it has been used in Washington and it does cover the basic areas.

SUPERINTENDENT EVALUATION

The following statements describe various aspects of a superintendent and his or her work: personal qualities, relationships with the board, community relationships, staff and personnel relationships, educational leadership, and business and finance.

For each item, there are three possible choices:

3 = Strong
2 = Satisfactory
1 = Weak

Please mark the (one) choice which most accurately describes your experience as a board member. You are encouraged to include comments. (If you fill this form out on a computer, you can expand the comments section as you type.)

PERSONAL QUALITIES

		3	2	1	Comments
	Defends principles and conviction in the face of pressure and partisan influence.				
	Maintains high standards of ethics, honesty, and integrity in all personal and professional matters.				
	Earns respect and standing among professional colleagues.				
	Devotes time and energy effectively to the job.				
	Demonstrates ability to work well with individuals and groups.				
	Exercises good judgment and democratic processes in arriving at decisions.				
	Possesses and maintains the health and energy necessary to meet the responsibilities of the position.				
	Maintains poise and emotional stability in the full range of professional activities.				
	Is suitably attired and well groomed.				
	Uses language effectively in dealing with staff members, the board, and the public.				
	Writes clearly and concisely.				
	Speaks well in front of large and small groups, expressing ideas in a logical and forthright manner.				
	Thinks well on his/her feet when faced with an unexpected or disturbing turn of events in a large group meeting.				
	Maintains professional development by reading, coursework, conference attendance, work on professional committees, visiting other districts, and meeting with other superintendents.				

RELATIONSHIPS WITH THE BOARD

	3	2	1	Comments
Keeps the board informed on issues, needs, and operation of the school system.				
Offers professional advice to the board on matters requiring board action, with recommendations based on appropriate study and analysis.				
Interprets and executes the intent of board policy.				
Seeks and accepts constructive criticism of work.				
Supports board policy and actions to the public and staff.				
Has a harmonious working relationship with the board.				
Understands role in administration of board personnel policy, makes recommendations for employment or promotion of personnel in writing and with appropriate supporting data.				
Accepts responsibility for maintaining liaison between the board and personnel, working toward a high degree of understanding and respect between the board and staff.				
Remains impartial toward the board, treating all board members alike.				
Refrains from criticism of individual or group members of the board.				
Goes immediately and directly to the board when he/she feels an honest, objective difference of opinion exists between him/her and any or all members of the board, in an earnest effort to resolve such difference immediately.				
Bases position with regard to matters discussed by the board upon principle, and is willing to maintain that position without regard for its popularity until an official position has been reached, after which time the superintendent supports the decision of the board, as long as he/she remains in its employ.				

COMMUNITY RELATIONSHIPS

	3	2	1	Comments
Gains respect and support of the community on the conduct of operation of the schools.				
Solicits and gives attention to problems and opinions of all groups and individuals.				
Develops friendly and cooperative relationships with news media.				
Participates actively in community life and affairs.				
Achieves status as a community leader in public education.				
Works effectively with public and private agencies.				

STAFF AND PERSONNEL RELATIONSHIPS

	3	2	1	Comments
Develops and executes sound personnel procedures and practices.				
Develops good employee morale and loyalty to the district.				
Treats personnel fairly, without favoritism or discrimination, while insisting on performance of duties.				
Delegates authority to administrative personnel appropriate to the position each holds.				
Recruits and assigns the best available personnel in terms of their competencies.				
Encourages participation of appropriate employees and groups in planning, procedures, and policy interpretation.				
Evaluates performance of appropriate administrative personnel, giving commendation for good work as well as requirements for improvement.				

EDUCATIONAL LEADERSHIP

		3	2	1	Comments
	Understands and keeps informed regarding significant aspects of the instructional program.				
	Implements the district's vision and improvement plan.				
	Participates with staff, board, and community in analyzing and evaluating instructional improvement.				
	Organizes a planned program of staff evaluation and improvement.				
	Inspires others to highest professional standards.				

BUSINESS AND FINANCE

		3	2	1	Comments
	Keeps informed on the needs of the school program – plant, facilities, equipment, and supplies.				
	Provides financial operation oversight, insisting on competent and effective performance.				
	Determines that funds are spent wisely, and adequate control and accounting are maintained.				
	Evaluates financial needs and makes recommendations for adequate, prudent budgets.				

OVERALL COMMENTS:

SIGNATURE OF SUPERINTENDENT

DATE

SIGNATURE OF BOARD PRESIDENT

DATE

One element which is not represented in the form above is the nature of the evidence a Board can look for in deciding how well the Superintendent has performed in a certain area. There are many indicators such as media reports, financial reports, indicators of morale, academic achievement, etc. If a Board were to wish to give the evaluation form more substance, then some of those indicators could be referenced.

The second major component would be the special annual goals for the Superintendent. There is a great deal of variation among school districts as to how or even whether these might be stated and addressed in evaluation. One of the approaches which seems most sound is to follow some basic guidelines as these goals are considered.

1. Goals for the Superintendent are most effective when they are agreed upon between the Board and Superintendent. This agreement is important for several reasons. Obviously it is critical for both parties to be working off the same agenda—the Board’s evaluation should be aimed at the priorities which the Superintendent expected and is focused upon. Another reason for collaboration on the goals is to insure that the number of goals for the year is practical—the Superintendent is directly or indirectly responsible for all of the district’s programs. However, it is important for the special priorities identified by the Board and Superintendent to be limited to five or six—more than that often leads to inability to focus adequately on all of them.

Another argument for Board and Superintendent agreement on the goals is to insure that the Superintendent is not overlooking some area that is important to the Board. If the Superintendent sets the goals unilaterally, they will likely be aimed at important topics, but may leave out something the Board is particularly interested in.

The discussion of Superintendent goals also provides opportunity to place the Board’s authority and interest behind these initiatives. The Superintendent usually finds more leverage for his/her special priorities when it is known that the Board shares the interest and support for them.

2. If the Superintendent is going to work toward some specific goals, it would be helpful if they are stated in a way which assures they will be intrinsically valuable to the district, practical in terms of working on them and measurable in terms of results. One of the documents shared with in preparation for this discussion described the “SMART” goal structure:
 - Strategic and specific—linked to the district’s purpose, vision and clearly stated.
 - Measurable—the Board and Superintendent agree on how they can tell if progress is made.
 - Attainable—the goals are practical and possible.
 - Results Oriented—the goals are stated in a way which describes outcomes (changes, accomplishments) rather than simply inputs, events, or intentions.
 - Time bound—there should be a specific timeline for specific actions and for determining whether the goals were achieved.

To summarize, it seems to work best if the Superintendent’s goals are recognized by the Board as important, are limited in number, are specific and related to the district’s mission (student learning), are practical, are described in terms of the results which are sought and will be evaluated in a specific timeframe.

ESTABLISHING A SYSTEM OF “ASSERTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY”

The next stage might be to consider how the Board and Superintendent could construct and agree upon a group of goals that they agree on as special emphases for the Superintendent for the year. A method which seems to work for some districts is to first agree on what is truly important for the district—i.e. a District Improvement Plan. This may already exist or it could be constructed to state the explicit areas of improvement the district is pursuing. It is in some ways a more precise statement than a strategic plan—it is a collection of the specific work to be done. It may also be the umbrella for the School Improvement Plans, and highlight the work which is the focus in the schools. However, it could well go further in that it sets the targets the Board and Superintendent wish to see the school district achieve. Out of these particular targets, the Superintendent may be working on four to six with specific attention. While he may not personally do all of the things involved in a goal, he will see that they happen, that they are measured, they are reported within the timeline set. The actual goals will frequently be mostly related to student learning, but could also involve district finance, facilities, collective bargaining, communications, etc.

[SAMPLE SUPERINTENDENT GOAL TEMPLATE]

Strategy		Desired Outcomes	Beginning – Comple. Date	Baseline	Measure for Growth	
*	Create, establish, and implement “pyramid of interventions”. We are currently working with HS principals to develop and implement. Status reports will be provided throughout the year as the strategies are developed and implemented.	1. Decrease dropout rate. 2. Retain more students. 3. Increase grad rate to reflect 9 th grade retention.	Sept 2008 – May 2010 (Data is posted by OSPI for 2008-09)	OSPI Information	1. 2008-09 Drop out rate is reduced to 5% 2. 2008-09 extended graduation rate is increased to 83% 3. Number of students retained gr 9 th -12 th , 08-09 thru 11-12	
				Unexcused Absence Rate (2007-08)		0.5%
				Annual Dropout Rate (2006-07)		6.1%
				On-Time Graduation Rate (2006-07)		71.0%
				Extended Graduation Rate (2006-07)		79.3%
				3. 2007-08 number of 12 th graders in district for 4 yrs		
*	Analyze the release of attendance data with a focus on secondary school data. Change the format of the report on waivers to give a true picture that is easy to understand. Improve and ensure accuracy of data. Track new enrollees and departing students on an ongoing basis as a retention and tracking strategy for waiver issues.	1. Improve student retention in the district. 2. Decrease the number of students who leave the district for educational reasons. 3. Accurate reporting for reasons people leave the district.	Sept – Dec 2008	1. Insert a chart here to reflect the current number of releases, acceptances for the past 5 years.	1. New report format developed and in use by Dec 2008. 2. Develop targets for 2009-10 based on analysis of data and new report.	
	Increase options for students to earn college credit and stay enrolled at the high schools such as - Dual Credit, running start, online learning, and AI task force.	1. High school students have more opportunities to receive college credits on high school campuses. 2. SD GPA’s are not negatively weighted by colleges.	Sept 2008 – April 2009	Create a baseline listing of current dual enrollment courses, most likely starting with tech-prep.	Create a listing of new dual enrollment possibilities and those added in 08-09. Report outcome of task force and Online committee along with recommendations for action in the 2009-10 school year.	

[ALTERNATIVE EXAMPLE—THE STATE ENDORSED ISLLC STANDARDS FOR ADMINISTRATIVE TRAINING AND PERFORMANCE]

Superintendent Evaluation – ISLLC Standards

ISLLC STANDARD #1 VISION OF LEARNING

Vision of Learning: facilitating the development, articulation, implementation and stewardship of a vision of learning that is shared by the school community.

ISLLC STANDARD #2 SCHOOL CULTURE AND INSTRUCTIONAL PROGRAM

School Culture and Instructional Program: advocating, nurturing and sustaining a school culture and instructional program conducive to student learning and staff professional growth.

ISLLC STANDARD #3 MANAGEMENT AND OPERATIONS

Management and Operations: ensures management of the organization, operations and resources for a safe, efficient and effective learning environment.

ISLLC STANDARD #4 COLLABORATION WITH FAMILIES AND COMMUNITY

Collaboration with Families & Community: Collaborates with families and community members, understanding and responding to diverse community interests and needs, and accessing community resources.

ISLLC STANDARD #5 INTEGRITY, FAIRNESS AND ETHICS

Integrity, Fairness and Ethics: Acts consistently with integrity, fairness and in an ethical manner.

ISLLC STANDARD #6 POLITICAL/SOCIAL/CULTURAL CONTEXT

Political, Social & Cultural Contexts: Understanding, responding to and influencing the larger political, social, economic, legal and cultural contexts.

Thank you for participating in this assessment. You will be answering a total of 110 questions 98 from the ISLLC standards and 12 from local standards. **Please be sure to answer every question or the results will not be accurate. Please mark only one answer for each question.** The following statements describe various aspects of a superintendent's performance: vision of learning, school culture and instructional program, management and operations, collaboration with families and community, integrity, fairness and ethics, political/social/cultural context, and relationships with the board. For each item, there are five possible choices:

- 5 = Commendable
- 4 = Exceeds Expectations
- 3 = Satisfactory
- 2 = Needs Improvement
- 1 = Unsatisfactory

Please mark the (one) choice which most accurately describes your experience as a board member. For any rating of "1" or "2" an explanation is necessary. You may also include comments for any specific rating or comments of a general nature.

ISLLC STANDARD #1 VISION OF LEARNING

Vision of Learning: facilitating the development, articulation, implementation and stewardship of a vision of learning that is shared by the school community.

The superintendent facilitates processes and engages in activities ensuring that:

the vision and mission of the school are effectively communicated to staff, parents, students, and community members	1 2 3 4 5
the vision and mission are communicated through the use of symbols, ceremonies, stories, and similar activities	1 2 3 4 5
the core beliefs of the school vision are modeled for all stakeholders	1 2 3 4 5
the vision is developed with and among stakeholders	1 2 3 4 5
the contributions of school community members to the realization of the vision are recognized and celebrated	1 2 3 4 5
progress toward the vision and mission is communicated to all stakeholders	1 2 3 4 5
the school community is involved in school improvement efforts	1 2 3 4 5
the vision shapes the educational programs, plans, and activities	1 2 3 4 5
the vision shapes the educational programs, plans, and actions	1 2 3 4 5
an implementation plan is developed in which objectives and strategies to achieve the vision and goals are clearly articulated	1 2 3 4 5
assessment data related to student learning are used to develop the school vision and goals	1 2 3 4 5
relevant demographic data pertaining to students and their families are used in developing the school mission and goals	1 2 3 4 5
barriers to achieving the vision are identified, clarified, and addressed	1 2 3 4 5
needed resources are sought and obtained to support the implementation of the school mission and goals	1 2 3 4 5
existing resources are used in support of the school vision and goals	1 2 3 4 5
the vision, mission, and implementation plans are regularly monitored, evaluated, and revised	1 2 3 4 5

STANDARD 1 COMMENTS:

ISLLC STANDARD #2 SCHOOL CULTURE AND INSTRUCTIONAL PROGRAM

School Culture and Instructional Program: advocating, nurturing and sustaining a school culture and instructional program conducive to student learning and staff professional growth.

The superintendent facilitates processes and engages in activities ensuring that:

all individuals are treated with fairness, dignity, and respect	1 2 3 4 5
professional development promotes a focus on student learning consistent with the school vision and goals	1 2 3 4 5
students and staff feel valued and important the responsibilities and contributions of each individual are acknowledged	1 2 3 4 5
barriers to student learning are identified, clarified, and addressed	1 2 3 4 5
diversity is considered in developing learning experiences	1 2 3 4 5
life long learning is encouraged and modeled	1 2 3 4 5
there is a culture of high expectations for self, student, and staff performance	1 2 3 4 5
technologies are used in teaching and learning	1 2 3 4 5
student and staff accomplishments are recognized and celebrated	1 2 3 4 5
multiple opportunities to learn are available to all students	1 2 3 4 5
the school is organized and aligned for success	1 2 3 4 5
curricular, co-curricular, and extra-curricular programs are designed, implemented, evaluated, and refined	1 2 3 4 5
curriculum decisions are based on research, expertise of teachers, and the recommendations of learned societies	1 2 3 4 5
the school culture and climate are assessed on a regular basis	1 2 3 4 5
a variety of sources of information is used to make decisions	1 2 3 4 5
student learning is assessed using a variety of techniques	1 2 3 4 5
multiple sources of information regarding performance are used by staff and students	1 2 3 4 5
a variety of supervisory and evaluation models is employed	1 2 3 4 5
pupil personnel programs are developed to meet the needs of students and their families	1 2 3 4 5

STANDARD 2 COMMENTS:

ISLLC STANDARD #3 MANAGEMENT AND OPERATIONS

Management and Operations: ensures management of the organization, operations and resources for a safe, efficient and effective learning environment.

The superintendent facilitates processes and engages in activities ensuring that:

knowledge of learning, teaching, and student development is used to inform management decisions	1 2 3 4 5
operational procedures are designed and managed to maximize opportunities for successful learning	1 2 3 4 5
emerging trends are recognized, studied, and applied as appropriate	1 2 3 4 5
operational plans and procedures to achieve the vision and goals of the school are in place	1 2 3 4 5
collective bargaining and other contractual agreements related to the school are effectively managed	1 2 3 4 5
the school plant, equipment, and support systems operate safely, efficiently, and effectively	1 2 3 4 5
time is managed to maximize attainment of organizational goals	1 2 3 4 5
potential problems and opportunities are identified	1 2 3 4 5
problems are confronted and resolved in a timely manner	1 2 3 4 5
financial, human, and material resources are aligned to the goals of schools	1 2 3 4 5
the school acts entrepreneurially to support continuous improvement	1 2 3 4 5
organizational systems are regularly monitored and modified as needed	1 2 3 4 5
stakeholders are involved in decisions affecting schools	1 2 3 4 5
responsibility is shared to maximize ownership and accountability	1 2 3 4 5
effective problem-framing and problemsolving skills are used	1 2 3 4 5
effective conflict resolution skills are used	1 2 3 4 5
effective group-process and consensusbuilding skills are used	1 2 3 4 5
effective communication skills are used	1 2 3 4 5
there is effective use of technology to manage school operations	1 2 3 4 5
fiscal resources of the school are managed responsibly, efficiently, and effectively	1 2 3 4 5
a safe, clean, and aesthetically pleasing school environment is created and maintained	1 2 3 4 5
human resource functions support the attainment of school goals	1 2 3 4 5
confidentiality and privacy of school records are maintained	1 2 3 4 5

STANDARD 3 COMMENTS:

ISLLC STANDARD #4 COLLABORATION WITH FAMILIES AND COMMUNITY

Collaboration With Families & Community: Collaborates with families and community members, understanding and responding to diverse community interests and needs, and accessing community resources.

The superintendent facilitates processes and engages in activities ensuring that:

high visibility, active involvement, and communication with the larger community is a priority	1 2 3 4 5
relationships with community leaders are identified and nurtured	1 2 3 4 5
information about family and community concerns, expectations, and needs is used regularly	1 2 3 4 5
there is outreach to different business, religious, political, and service agencies and organizations	1 2 3 4 5
credence is given to individuals and groups whose values and opinions may conflict	1 2 3 4 5
the school and community serve one another as resources	1 2 3 4 5
available community resources are secured to help the school solve problems and achieve goals	1 2 3 4 5
partnerships are established with area businesses, institutions of higher education, and community groups to strengthen programs and support school goals	1 2 3 4 5
community youth family services are integrated with school programs	1 2 3 4 5
community stakeholders are treated equitably	1 2 3 4 5
diversity is recognized and valued	1 2 3 4 5
effective media relations are developed and maintained	1 2 3 4 5
a comprehensive program of community relations is established	1 2 3 4 5
public resources and funds are used appropriately and wisely	1 2 3 4 5
community collaboration is modeled for staff	1 2 3 4 5
opportunities for staff to develop collaborative skills are provided	1 2 3 4 5

STANDARD 4 COMMENTS:

ISLLC STANDARD #5 INTEGRITY, FAIRNESS AND ETHICS

Integrity, Fairness and Ethics: Acts consistently with integrity, fairness and in an ethical manner.

The superintendent:

examines personal and professional values	1	2	3	4	5
demonstrates a personal and professional code of ethics	1	2	3	4	5
demonstrates values, beliefs, and attitudes that inspire others to higher levels of performance	1	2	3	4	5
serves as a role model	1	2	3	4	5
accepts responsibility for school operations	1	2	3	4	5
considers the impact of one's administrative practices on others	1	2	3	4	5
uses the influence of the office to enhance the educational program rather than for personal gain	1	2	3	4	5
treats people fairly, equitably, and with dignity and respect	1	2	3	4	5
protects the rights and confidentiality of students and staff	1	2	3	4	5
demonstrates appreciation for and sensitivity to the diversity in the school community	1	2	3	4	5
recognizes and respects the legitimate authority of others	1	2	3	4	5
examines and considers the prevailing values of the diverse school community	1	2	3	4	5
expects that others in the school community will demonstrate integrity and exercise ethical behavior	1	2	3	4	5
opens the school to public scrutiny	1	2	3	4	5
fulfills legal and contractual obligations	1	2	3	4	5
applies laws and procedures fairly, wisely, and considerately	1	2	3	4	5

STANDARD 5 COMMENTS:

ISLLC STANDARD #6 POLITICAL/SOCIAL/CULTURAL CONTEXT

Political, Social & Cultural Contexts: Understanding, responding to and influencing the larger political, social, economic, legal and cultural contexts.

The superintendent facilitates processes and engages in activities ensuring that:

the environment in which schools operate is influenced on behalf of students and their families	1 2 3 4 5
communication occurs among the school community concerning trends, issues, and potential changes in the environment in which schools operate	1 2 3 4 5
there is ongoing dialogue with representatives of diverse community groups	1 2 3 4 5
the school community works within the framework of policies, laws, and regulations enacted by local, state, and federal authorities	1 2 3 4 5
public policy is shaped to provide quality education for students	1 2 3 4 5
lines of communication are developed with decision makers outside the school community	1 2 3 4 5

STANDARD 6 COMMENTS:

STANDARD #7 POLITICAL/SOCIAL/CULTURAL CONTEXT

Superintendent-Board Relationship Context: Understanding, responding to and cultivating the relationship with the board within the context of the Board-Superintendent Operating Principles.

The superintendent facilitates processes and engages in activities ensuring that:

Keeps the board informed on issues, needs, and operation of the school system.	1 2 3 4 5
Offers professional advice to the board on matters requiring board action, with recommendations based on appropriate study and analysis.	1 2 3 4 5
Interprets and executes the intent of board policy.	1 2 3 4 5
Seeks and accepts constructive criticism of work.	1 2 3 4 5
Supports board policy and actions to the public and staff.	1 2 3 4 5
Has a harmonious working relationship with the board.	1 2 3 4 5
Understands role in administration of board personnel policy, makes recommendations for employment or promotion of personnel in writing and with appropriate supporting data.	1 2 3 4 5
Accepts responsibility for maintaining liaison between the board and personnel, working toward a high degree of understanding and respect between the board and staff.	1 2 3 4 5
Remains impartial toward the board, treating all board members alike.	1 2 3 4 5
Refrains from criticism of individual or group members of the board.	1 2 3 4 5
Goes immediately and directly to the board when he/she feels an honest, objective difference of opinion exists between him/her and any or all members of the board, in an earnest effort to resolve such difference immediately.	1 2 3 4 5
Bases position with regard to matters discussed by the board upon principle, and is willing to maintain that position without regard for its popularity until an official position has been reached, after which time the superintendent supports the decision of the board, as long as he/she remains in its employ.	1 2 3 4 5

STANDARD 7 COMMENTS:

OVERALL COMMENTS:

WSSDA-WASA Sample Superintendent Contract

The following is intended to provide a template for a basic contract for the employment of a superintendent. It contains provisions generally recommended in such employment contracts.

_____ **School District**

It is hereby agreed by and between the Board of Directors (the Board) of the _____ School District No. _____ (the District), _____ County, Washington and _____ (the Superintendent) that the Board, in accordance with its action as reflected in the minutes of the meeting held on _____ (***month, day, year***), has and does hereby employ _____ as Superintendent of Schools for a contract period commencing July 1, _____ through June 30, _____ (***term is typically three years, can be one or two***), on the terms and conditions set out in this contract. Each year of the contract shall include _ _ _ work days (***the number of work days range from 240 to 260 work days***) minus twelve (12) paid holidays and twenty-five (25) paid vacation days for an actual work year of _ _ _ days (***the number of actual work days may range from 203 to 223***). Both parties agree that _____ shall perform the duties of the Superintendent of Schools of the District as prescribed by the laws of the State of Washington and by the rules and regulations made thereunder by the Board.

Terms and Conditions

1. In consideration of an annual salary to be paid at the rate of one-twelfth (1/12) of \$_____ each month beginning July 1, 20_ _, the Superintendent agrees to perform faithfully the duties of the Superintendent of Schools and to serve as Executive Officer and Secretary to the Board. The Superintendent's salary is subject to adjustment in accordance with the terms of this contract. Any increases granted shall be subject to limitations of law pertaining thereto.
2. Subject to Board approval, the Superintendent shall be responsible to select, organize, reorganize and arrange the administrative and supervisory staff in such manner as best serves the District; to administer the District's instructional program and business affairs; and to select, place, and transfer personnel. The Board, individually and collectively, will refer promptly all significant criticisms, complaints and suggestions called to its attention to the Superintendent for study and recommendation.
3. The Superintendent shall regularly report to the Board on the affairs of the District by such methods as the Board shall direct.
4. Prior to June 15 of each succeeding school year, the parties will meet to establish goals and objectives for the next succeeding school year, in the same manner and with the same effect as heretofore described. Said goals and objectives shall be among the criteria by which the Superintendent is evaluated as hereafter provided.
5. The Board shall devote a least two (2) meetings annually to a discussion of the working relationship between the Superintendent and the Board. The discussion shall include an evaluation of the Superintendent's performance as measured by the evaluative criteria and goals and objectives established by the Board and Superintendent.
6. The contract of the Superintendent will be reviewed by the Board annually on or before _____ (***month, day***), to consider whether a new three (3)-year contract shall be awarded in lieu of the remaining portion of this contract, or whether this contract, for expressed reasons, shall continue toward its maturity. (***Note: The parties may wish to specify a date between February 1***

and June 15. Earlier notification of decision not to extend may provide the Superintendent an opportunity to seek other employment, while providing the Board the opportunity to seek a new Superintendent.) The annual salary will be increased for each contract year on the basis of an annual survey of salaries in comparable school districts, subject to Board determination of fully satisfactory performance by the Superintendent and provided that in no event will the salary be reduced.

7. Consistent with law, the Superintendent agrees to have a comprehensive medical examination not less than once every two (2) years. A statement certifying to the medical competency of the Superintendent shall be available to the Board upon request and shall be treated as confidential information by the Board. The costs of the examination shall be borne by the District.
8. In lieu of other expense reimbursement for in-District travel, the Superintendent shall receive \$_____ per month to defray costs incurred in using his/her automobile for official travel. (Pursuant to RCW 42.24.090, it is the determination of the Board that this means of reimbursement is less costly than providing an automobile to the Superintendent.) The Superintendent will also be entitled to out-of-District mileage and other expense reimbursement for official business as provided by law and District policy for certificated administrators.
9. The Superintendent shall receive twenty-five (25) days vacation annually exclusive of legal holidays. Not less than ten (10) days of vacation shall be taken during each contract year. Unused vacation may be carried over from year to year to a maximum of forty (40) days. Additionally, the Superintendent is entitled to twelve (12) paid holidays per calendar year. Vacation days shall be deemed used in the order in which they were earned. The Superintendent shall be compensated for up to a maximum of thirty (30) days of unused vacation remaining at the termination of this contract at a rate of $1/2$ _ _ **(the fraction should have a logical connection to days in the work year: e.g., 1/203, 1/223, etc; see the calculation in the contract preamble)** of the annual salary for each day.
10. The Superintendent shall receive twelve (12) days annual sick leave with compensation for illness, injury, and emergency, with unused leave treated in accordance with law and District policy for certificated administrators.
11. The Superintendent shall be eligible to participate in a tax-sheltered annuity program, such annuity to be selected by the Superintendent. The annual salary described in paragraph 1, above, shall be augmented by an amount equal to \$_____ each month, to be applied to the purchase of such annuity. It is intended that all amounts so applied will be excluded from the gross income of the Superintendent under Sections 402(g) and 403(b) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986, as amended. The Superintendent has the option of on each anniversary date of the contract to either continue this contribution or to receive the amount as salary. Each election shall be irrevocable once made.
12. The Superintendent shall devote his/her time, attention and energy to the business of the District; however, he/she may serve as a consultant to other districts or educational agencies on his/her off-duty time.
13. The Superintendent shall attend appropriate professional meetings at the local, state and national level, the expenses of said attendance to be incurred by the District. The Superintendent also agrees to maintain membership and active participation in the Washington Association of School Administrators (WASA) and the American Association of School Administrators (AASA), and do so at District expense.

14. The Superintendent shall be afforded insurance coverage, leaves, and other benefits commensurate with those provided other certificated administrators employed by the District.
15. The Superintendent agrees to maintain membership and active participation in the local Chamber of Commerce and in one local service club and do so at District expense in accordance with Board policy.
16. The Superintendent shall establish and maintain his/her primary residence within the bounds of the District.
17. The Superintendent shall fulfill all aspects of this contract, any exception hereto being by mutual consent of the Board and the Superintendent. Ethical violations will be viewed as a violation of the Administrators' Code of Ethics. All violations will be reported by the Board to the Association of School Administrators and state educational authorities, in addition to any other remedy provided by law.
18. During the term of this agreement, the Superintendent will be subject to discharge for cause.
19. The Board agrees, as a further condition of the Superintendent's employment contract, that it will defend, hold harmless and indemnify the Superintendent, and to the extent allowed by law, his/her community property, from any and all third party demands, claims, suits, actions, damages, costs, charges and expenses, including court costs and attorney's fees; provided that the incident out of which such demands, claims, suits, actions, damages, costs, charges and expenses arise has occurred while the Superintendent is acting within the scope of his/her employment and during the good faith performance of his/her contract.
20. This contract shall be subject to and interpreted consistent with the laws of the State of Washington. If any provision of this contract shall be found to be contrary to law or state regulation, then such provision shall be deemed not valid except to the extent permitted by law, but all other provisions of this contract shall continue in full force and effect.
21. This contract represents the entire contract between the parties regarding the employment of the Superintendent by the District and there are no oral agreements that modify its terms.
22. This contract supplants the parties' _____ (*specify years of previous contract*) contract, effective July 1, 20__.

DATED this _____ day of _____.

President, Board of Directors

_____ School District

Superintendent

_____ School District

Other forms of compensation may be considered. If the parties add additional contract language, the language must be reviewed by an attorney prior to any Board action to approve the Superintendent contract.